AI use in CV preparation

Job and postgraduate applications among final-year XJTLU students

A survey of students' recent experiences

Presentation 2
19 October 2026

Research focus

Main question

How does satisfaction with a prepared CV differ between students who used AI and those who did not?

Further questions

What do students use AI for?
How do they rate its functions, benefits and difficulties?

Application purpose: job or postgraduate study

We compare reported experiences. The survey does not measure objective CV quality.

Survey design and participants

Why a survey

Capture real CV experiences across different AI tools. A shared satisfaction scale supports comparison.

Who and when

XJTLU final-year students aged 18+; a CV in the past six months. Recall the most recent preparation.

Sampling

Convenience sampling through student groups; snowball referrals. Target: 40-60 eligible responses.

AI use in the recalled event defines the groups. Eligibility is checked at the start.

Questionnaire content

Everyone

Application purpose and field
Previous CV experience
AI use in the recalled event
CV satisfaction (1-7)

AI users

Uses and perceived help (1-7)
Function ratings (1-10)
Inaccurate suggestions noticed
Optional benefits or difficulties

Non-users

Reasons for non-use
Future use intention (1-7)

Analysis and interpretation

Main comparison	Two independent groups; ordinal satisfaction (1-7). Two-sided Mann-Whitney U; effect size and uncertainty.
Eligible answers	Include respondents who report whether they used AI and give a valid CV satisfaction score (1-7).
Reporting	Show group sizes, score distributions and medians. Summarise AI use, function ratings and feedback.

We examine the relationship between AI use and satisfaction; other factors may also influence the results.

Method: NIST, Rank Sum Test

Study procedure and participant protection

Participation	Read the information sheet; consent and eligibility. Declining or ineligible respondents exit the survey.
Survey flow	Recall one event; answer the shared satisfaction item. Follow the AI-use branch, then submit.
Data protection	No names, student IDs or CV uploads requested. Restrict access to responses; report aggregate findings.